2015 Mazda3 i Grand Touring Hatchback

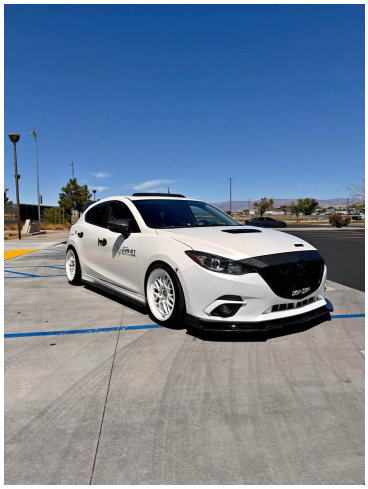
$13,800 · 78,600 miles · Private seller · Ridgecrest, CA

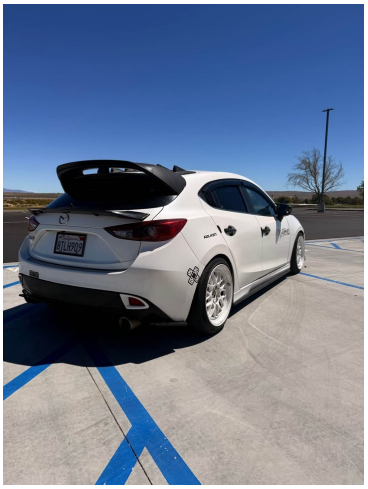
Seller: Private seller

Source: Facebook Marketplace

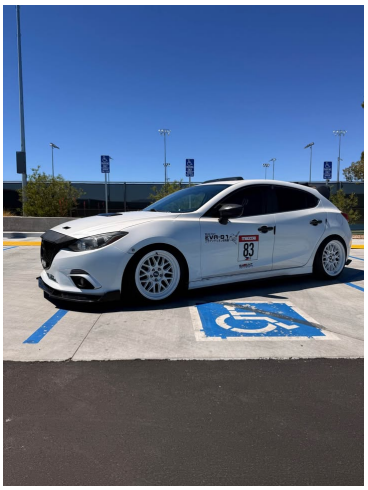
Listing: https://www.facebook.com/marketplace/item/1263271368765158/

Report generated October 31, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









+ 4 more photos in the app.

Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$15,354	**$581**	**Good**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	4/5 · 4 recalls · 129 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$13,800.00
Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV	$1,276.50
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$89.70
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$65.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$15,354.20
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$5,000.00
Amount financed	$10,354.20
Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR)	$207.48
Total interest over the loan	$2,094.42
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$5,150.00

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$207.48
Insurance (estimate, full)	$135.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 33 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$143.94
Maintenance & repair reserve	$75.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$19.97
Total per month	$581.39

Running costs without the loan: **$374/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$20,708** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: typical car. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Good (4/5)

Good. 3rd-gen Mazda3 (2014-2018) with the 2.0L Skyactiv and a conventional 6-speed automatic (no CVT) is one of the more reliable compacts of its era, and the lowest-mileage car on your list. 30 city / 40 hwy MPG.

NHTSA data for this model year: 4 recalls · 129 owner complaints (8 involving a crash). Most complaints: Service Brakes (26), Unknown Or Other (26), Electrical System (24), Back Over Prevention (12), Fuel/Propulsion System (12), Engine (6).

Known issues for this model

• Mazda Connect touchscreen 'ghost touch' / freezing (2014-2016 Grand Touring)

• A/C condenser or compressor failures reported

• Some carbon buildup on direct-injection engines at higher miles

• Aftermarket/aesthetic mods: check nothing affects smog or insurance

• Recalls (4): fuel tank, parking-brake caliper (water can enter), rearview camera - confirm done by VIN

Check on this car before buying

• Confirm the smog certificate date (valid 90 days)

• Test the infotainment screen and backup camera

• A/C cold after 15 min

• Look at the 'few small dents' and any mod wiring

• Run VIN for open recalls

Notes

$13,800 OBO, 78,600 mi, automatic, white/black, 2.0L Skyactiv. 2 owners, paid off, CLEAN TITLE in hand, tags current, SMOG DONE, 0 accidents.

Seller: runs great; few small dents; front door speakers old; aesthetic mods (carbon fiber), no engine mods. Selling for a truck down payment.

Listed ~26 weeks -> negotiate. Over the ~$10k budget at asking.

Seller won't answer the auto 'Is this still available?' message - write a real message.

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.